



EA Play on Xbox Games Pass
Xbox Game Pass Ultimate subscribers will get access to EA Play.
<http://dgit.in/oct20-69>



20ms satellite internet
SpaceX's satellite internet service, Starlink, has achieved a latency under 20 milliseconds. <http://dgit.in/oct20-70>

HP Envy 15

Built for creators

The HP Envy 15 is a sleek looking laptop that's aimed squarely at content creators.

Powered by the 10th generation Intel Core i7-10750H processor and an Nvidia GeForce GTX 1660Ti, the HP Envy 15 makes a few choices that set it apart from gaming laptops. But at the end of the day, is this the right laptop for content creators or should they look somewhere else?



Build and Design

The HP Envy 15 features a nice white backlit chiclet-style keyboard. The keyboard is a treat to use, with generously sized keycaps and decent distance between the keys. Where the keyboard is a little weird is that it removes the right CTRL key and puts a fingerprint sensor there.

The I/O on the Envy is rather impressive. You get two Thunderbolt 3.0 ports, a full-sized HDMI port and two USB 3.0 ports. For any creator, this should be sufficient enough. However, it is sad to see that they do not support PowerDelivery.

The HP Envy trades the traditional copper pipe-based cooling system for a vapour chamber. While running our standard 4K 20-minute timeline export, the Intel Core i7-10750H stays well in the 80s for the most part, spiking into the early 90s only momentarily. While the internals maintain a good temperate zone, the surface temperature is a different story. The use of aluminium for the keyboard island allows it to also act as a heat dissipator; hence, you will feel the heat from the inside. Perhaps the most surprising find was the palm-rest, which we measured to be at 41.5 degrees Celsius. Suffice to say, if you're gaming on this thing or running a sustained render load, this thing is



BUILD AND DESIGN.....77
PERFORMANCE.....79
VALUE.....76
FEATURE.....70

definitely going to feel hot. The HP Envy 15 packs a full HD IPS panel with a rated brightness of 300 nits and 100 percent sRGB coverage. We measured the panel brightness numbers to be close to what HP claims and as for the colour accuracy, the display seems to be calibrated right out of the box. The white point is set for the sRGB colourspace, which is nice.

Performance

Our testing for creative workloads involves Adobe Lightroom and Adobe Premiere. In addition, we also tested the Envy using DaVinci Resolve, Blender, Apophysis fractal rendering program and Photoshop to see just how the laptop keeps up with these specific workloads. We exported a batch of 50, 100 and 500 RAW files all shot using a Nikon Z7 through Adobe Lightroom Classic. In this test, the Envy surprisingly recorded some very slow render times.

Switching over to Premiere Pro, we see a completely different behaviour. Now Premiere Pro intelligently shifts the loads between the CPU and GPU depending on the matter being rendered. Here, faster renders are also aided by Intel's QuickSync technology. Here, we noted that the HP Envy does admirably well, recording the fastest

render times across all the 10th gen gaming laptops and even the Ryzen 4000 ones we've tested.

HP is not positioning the Envy 15 as a gaming laptop, but it would be ridiculous to not consider it as one. We ran our standard suite of games on the Envy and found that it actually manages the 60fps mark across most games with their graphics setting set to the High or Medium preset. The Envy sports only a 60Hz display, so we're more than happy to see games hit that mark. It's smooth and free from any kind of tearing and that's pretty much all you can hope for. Where the Envy falters as a gaming system is due to the

fact that after a few hours of sustained gaming, the surface temperatures do get really hot.

Bottom Line

The HP Envy 15 is trying to take on brands that have practically ruled the kingdom. However at the same time, the MacBook Pro and the new Dell XPS 15 are considerably expensive, so the HP Envy 15 does fill up a massive price gap that currently exists. The review unit we received retails for ₹1,49,999, currently being the cheapest of the creator laptops with Intel's 10th generation processors. You could bump up the specs to an RTX 2060 and an OLED display if you wanted and still not hit the price point of the Dell or the MacBook Pro. The Envy does manage to deliver on the promise of good performance for creative workloads and can also easily hold its own when it comes to gaming. For the price, it does truly offer solid value for money and can be a solid recommendation for those who don the role of content creators and gamers.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-10750H | RAM: 16GB DDR4 | GPU: Nvidia GeForce GTX 1660Ti (6GB VRAM) | STORAGE: 1TB Samsung NVMe | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 1920x1080 | DISPLAY REFRESH RATE: 60Hz

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